

Nikhil Sharma

Operations Management & Business Analytics
Fisher College of Business, The Ohio State University

On the 2026–2027 academic job market

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RESEARCH

Methodology & Empirical Toolkit

Primary & Secondary Data Collection, Field Experiments, Lab Experiments, Applied Econometrics, Causal Inference, Synthetic Controls, Matching, Decomposition, NLP / LLM-based text classification, Causal Machine Learning

Job Market Paper

2026 *Job Market Paper · Target Submission: October 2026 · M&SOM*

Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain

Sharma, N., Gray, J., & De Jong, J.

Under Review

2026 *Preparing for Resubmission (Reject and Resubmit) · M&SOM*

Improving Recycling Quality through AI and Green Nudges: Evidence from a Field Experiment

McKie, E., Sharma, N., Chandrasekaran, A., & Cho, S.

2026 *Preparing for Resubmission (3rd Round Major Revision) · Journal of Business Logistics*

Supply Chain Intermediaries' Value Contribution: A Review and Future Opportunities

Sharma, N., Hughes, M., Gray, J., & De Jong, J.

An integrative literature review developing a conceptual framework on how and when supply chain intermediaries create and destroy value.

2026 *Preparing for Resubmission (Revision Granted) · Health Affairs Scholar*

Generic Drug Supply Chain Quality and Market Dynamics: A Cross-Sectional Observational Study of Metformin

Gray, J. V., Handfield, R., Divey, S., Sahebi-Fakhrabad, A., Sadeghi, A., Sharma, N., Light, D., Butler, P., Teasdale, B., & Schulman, K. A.

Working Papers

2026 **Multiproduct Retail Decisions under Aggregate Contracts**

Sharma, N., Hill, J., & Mallipeddi, R.

- Dissertation Chapter 2 · Lab Study 1 complete, Lab Study 2 in planning
- Presented at POMS 2026

Research in Progress

- 2026 **The Impact of Curbing Intermediary Practices on Retailers' Performance**
Sharma, N., Gray, J., & De Jong, J.
• Dissertation Chapter 3 · Data collection complete
- 2026 **Multi-contract Retail Decisions under Third-Party Payments**
Sharma, N., Hill, J., & Mallipeddi, R.
• Experiment design complete

Research Awards

- 2025 **First Place, Edward F. Hayes Advanced Research Forum, The Ohio State University**
Business category, for the dissertation paper “Regulating a Powerful Intermediary: The Effectiveness of Laws to Eliminate Adverse Pharmacy Benefit Manager Practices.”

TEACHING

Instructor, Fisher College of Business

- 2025 **BUSMGT 3230: Introduction to Operations Management**
Instructor of record for 36 students · **SEI: 4.8 / 5.0**

Graduate Teaching Assistant, Fisher College of Business

- 2022–2025 **BUSMGT 3230: Introduction to Operations Management (x2)**
Including one fully online recitation.
- 2022–2025 **BUSMGT 7223, BUSMGT 2320, BUSOBA 2321, BUSOBA 4234, BUSOBA 4254, MBA 6273, BUSOBA 7201**
Project Management; Decision Sciences: Statistical Techniques; Business Analytics; Service Operations; Sustainable Projects; Data Analysis Management; Service Operations.

Earlier Teaching

- 2016–2017 **Mentor, Starbase CT, Hartford, CT**
Public speaking and robotics.
- 2013 **Ad Hoc Instructor, Accenture Learning & Knowledge Management**

EDUCATION

- 2022–present **Ph.D., Operations Management & Business Analytics (expected May 2027)**
Fisher College of Business, The Ohio State University.
Dissertation Committee: John Gray (Chair), James Hill, Jurriaan De Jong, Rakesh Mallipeddi.
- 2005–2009 **B.E., Electronics and Communications**
Institute of Technology & Management, Gurgaon, India (Maharshi Dayanand University, Rohtak)

CONFERENCES & PRESENTATIONS

Upcoming

- 2026 **INFORMS Annual Meeting**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.
“Supply Chains, E-Commerce, and Intermediaries” Session, 2:45–4:00 PM, Sunday, November 1
(Moscone South-202, Level 2).
- 2026 **DSI Annual Conference**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.
Multiproduct Retail Decisions under Aggregate Contracts.
- 2026 **AI in Business Conference, Fisher College of Business**
Session Chair.

Past

- 2026 **ISA Annual Meeting**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.
- 2026 **POMS Annual Conference**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.
Multiproduct Retail Decisions under Aggregate Contracts.
- 2025 **DSI Annual Conference**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.
- 2025 **UIUC Supply Chain Management Conference**
Improving Recycling Quality through AI and Green Nudges.
- 2025 **POMS Annual Conference**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.
- 2025 **Indian School of Business (ISB) – POMS Workshop**
Regulating Powerful Intermediaries: An Empirical Assessment in the Retail Pharmacy Supply Chain.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

- 2025–present **Emerging-Scholar Ambassadorial Core (ESAC), Journal of Operations Management**
Involved in the creation of “The Doctorate in Operations Management Embassy (D.O.M.E.)”
- 2025–2027 **Session Chair**
POMS (2027, 2026), INFORMS Annual Meeting (2026), DSI Annual Conference (2025, 2026), AI in
Business Conference, Fisher College of Business (2026).
- 2026 **Panel Co-Moderator**
DSI Panel on AI in Healthcare.
- 2026 **Ad-Hoc Reviewer**
Decision Sciences Journal.

Professional Memberships

INFORMS, Production and Operations Management Society (POMS), Decision Sciences Institute (DSI), Industry Studies Association (ISA).

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Accenture, India & USA (2009–2022)

12 years across information systems, production operations, and business analytics, with exposure to Financial Services, Life Sciences, Communication/Media/Technology, and Health & Public Services domains.

2014–2022 **Business Analytics Consulting, Travelers (Business Insurance), Hartford, CT**

2013–2014 **Business Analyst, Biopharmaceutical Research, Covance (LabCorp), Bangalore, India**

2012–2013 **Product Development, KPN (Communication, Media & Technology), Bangalore, India**

2009–2012 **Production Operations & Quality Analyst, United Health Group, Bangalore, India**

Industry Awards

2019 **Top 5 Finalist Team, Accenture Global Tech Innovation Contest (North America)**
Chicago, IL, out of 350+ entries. Pitched in the “Innovate for Society” category:
• Enhancing transparency in CSR donations
• Providing a digital identity for street vendors using blockchain platforms
Collaborators: Prakash Trivedi, Saurabh Gaikwad, Surendra Kushwaha, Ravindra Pratap Singh.

2018 **Top 5 Finalist Team, Accenture Global Tech Innovation Contest (North America)**
Chicago, IL, out of 350+ entries. Pitched in the “Innovate for Society” category:
• Transforming the Public Distribution System in developing countries using blockchain to fight corruption
Collaborators: Prakash Trivedi, Saurabh Gaikwad, Ravindra Pratap Singh.

SKILLS & TRAINING

Programming Languages & Software

R, STATA, LaTeX, Python, MS Office

Technology & Platform Training

Ab Initio, Databricks, AWS

Industry Exposure

Healthcare & Insurance, Pharmaceutical Technology, Communications/Media/Technology, General Insurance (P&C)

REFERENCES

John Gray

Dean’s Distinguished Professor of Operations; Chair,
Operations & Business Analytics, Fisher College of
Business, The Ohio State University
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James A. Hill

Professor of Operations Management, Fisher College of
Business, The Ohio State University
hill.249@osu.edu · 614-247-8965

Aravind Chandrasekaran

Interim Dean; John W. Berry, Sr. Chair in Business,
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Rakesh Mallipeddi

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